ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE K

WITHOUT raising your tax rate, VOTE YES on Measure K to repair aging TK-8 neighborhood schools, protect student safety, and improve the quality of education in Fallbrook Union Elementary School District.

Our neighborhood elementary and junior high schools are aging and in DIRE need of repairs. Five of FUESD's ten schools are nearly 60 years old, while Fallbrook STEM Academy is 77 and Maie Ellis Elementary School is now 88! Time has taken its toll. Repairs to roofs, plumbing, electrical, HVAC and water systems are desperately needed.

In fact, it's been nearly 25 years since we passed a FUESD bond. Measure K provides a prudent, responsible plan to fix OUR schools. NO other funding currently exists to address the magnitude of need!

Passage of Measure K will:

- **Repair** our neighborhood schools **WITHOUT increasing tax rates**
- **Remove** asbestos
- **Replace** decaying water pipes
- **Upgrade** failing roofs, plumbing, and electrical systems
- **Renovate** classrooms for modern science, technology, engineering, arts and math instruction
- **Improve** school safety/security

Measure K WON'T raise your tax rate. It simply extends WITHOUT increasing the soon-to-expire bond authorization originally approved by FUESD voters in 2002. VOTING YES continues locally controlled funding to address needed school repairs and upgrades, **keeping your existing tax rate FLAT.**

Taxpayer protections are MANDATORY:

- **ALL funds STAY LOCAL**. The State CANNOT take this funding away
- **NOTHING** is allowed for administrators' salaries/pensions
- Required Citizens' Oversight and independent audits ensure proper spending

With prudent steps that Fallbrook Union Elementary School District has taken as a good steward of taxpayer dollars, the **San Diego County Taxpayers Association urges a "YES VOTE" on Measure K.**

Passing Measure K qualifies Fallbrook Union Elementary School District **to receive millions in State matching funds, leveraging local taxpayer dollars even further.**

Please, join the **San Diego** County Taxpayers Association, teachers, parents, children's advocates and residents across Fallbrook **VOTING YES** for OUR children and neighborhood schools **WITHOUT raising tax rates.**

VOTE YES on K.
www.YesForFUESDschools.com

MARK KERSEY
San Diego County Taxpayers Association President and CEO

DR. ANA ARIAS
Elementary School Principal, 30-yr. Educator

DR. MALCOLM "STEVE" JONES
Veterinarian, Local Business Owner

DALE MITCHELL
Retired Superintendent, FUHSD

DR. CONNIE FISH
Retired, 33-yr. Educator, Fallbrook Center for the Arts, Inc. Liaison

No Argument Against Measure K was filed with the Office of the Registrar of Voters.

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE K

The following is the full proposition presented to the voters by the Fallbrook Union Elementary School District.

"To update local elementary and middle schools without increasing tax rates; replace failing roofs, plumbing and electrical systems; improve school safety; construct/repair/acquire classrooms, labs, facilities, equipment, and sites; and qualify for State matching funds; shall Fallbrook Union Elementary School District's measure be adopted, authorizing $76,000,000 in bonds at legal rates, levying a projected $30 per $100,000 assessed value while bonds are outstanding, generating $5,000,000 annually, with public oversight, audits, no funds for administrators, all funds staying local?"

PROJECT LIST

The Governing Board of the Fallbrook Union Elementary School District is committed to **maintaining the quality of education** in our local public schools by **repairing and upgrading local elementary and middle schools** and providing safe, secure, modern classrooms, labs and technology needed to support high-quality instruction in **science, technology, engineering, arts** and **math**. To that end, the Board evaluated the District's urgent and critical facility needs, including safety issues, class size reduction, **basic repairs,** and computer and information technology, in developing the types of projects to be funded by this measure as described below.

This bond includes strict accountability requirements to make sure public funds are used appropriately. These requirements include public disclosure of all spending, independent annual financial and performance audits, and the formation of a committee of local citizens and business owners to ensure all spending is in line with the promises made in the measure. What's more, by law, all funds must be used to improve our local schools and cannot be taken by Sacramento, the federal government, the County, or anyone else.

In approving this Project List, the Board of Education determines that the District **must:**

(i) Update local elementary and middle schools without increasing tax rates; and

(ii) Replace failing roofs, plumbing, and electrical systems; and

(iii) Improve school safety; and

(iv) Adhere to specific fiscal accountability safeguards such as:

(a) REQUIRE ALL FUNDS USED FOR LOCAL ELEMENTARY AND MIDDLE SCHOOLS,

(b) Prohibit the State from taking any of the funds raised,

(c) Require annual independent audits, and

(d) Require public disclosure of all spending.

The Project List includes the following types of upgrades and improvements at District schools, facilities and sites:

LOCALLY CONTROLLED FUNDING FOR SCHOOL IMPROVEMENTS

School Repair, Safety and Upgrade Projects

Goals and Purposes:

Some school buildings are approaching 90 years old, well past their expected lifespan. This measure will replace school roofs, windows, plumbing, HVAC, and energy systems now to avoid ongoing costly repairs.

There is nothing more important than keeping our young children safe at school. This measure will improve student safety by protecting pick-up and drop-off zones from nearby traffic, adding more controlled campus access, and replacing old fire alarms and emergency communication systems.

- Improving school safety.
- **Replacing failing roofs.**
- Replacing failing plumbing and electrical systems.
- Qualifying for State matching funds.
- **Replacing decaying water pipes.**
- Replacing failing heating and cooling systems.
- Updating pickup and drop-off areas to improve student safety.
- Weather-proofing schools to avoid mold and dry rot.
- Removing asbestos from schools.

SUPPORT HIGH QUALITY INSTRUCTION IN MATH, SCIENCE, ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

Projects That Improve Student Success

Goals and Purposes:

This measure will update classrooms and labs to meet today's standards for science, technology, engineering, arts and math, so that our graduates are well-prepared for high school, and go on to become leaders in college and the future workforce.

Bond measures are how California school districts pay for essential school repairs and updates. Passing this measure will also qualify Fallbrook Union Elementary School District for millions of dollars in matching funds from the State - money that would otherwise go to other districts.

- Updating classrooms and labs.
- **Upgrading classrooms for science, technology, engineering, arts and math.**
- Replacing aging portables with permanent classrooms.
- Updating labs for early job training programs.

In addition to the projects listed above, the repair and renovation of each of the existing school and District support facilities may include, but not be limited to, some or all of the following: add, upgrade, or renovate student and staff restrooms; repair, replace and upgrade electrical, plumbing, heating, ventilation, air conditioning, and building systems; upgrade of facilities for energy efficiencies, electrical generation and financial savings, including solar panels; improve accessibility for students, staff and the public with disabilities; repair, upgrade, construct, and replace worn-out and deteriorated roofs, gutters, windows, walls, tackboards, floors, sinks, doors and drinking fountains/hydration stations and portable classrooms; construct, improve or renovate offices and facilities for multipurpose and indoor/outdoor learning spaces, professional development, front-offices, and administration and for the safety of students on campuses; install wiring and electrical systems to safely accommodate computers, technology and other electrical devices; upgrade, replace, repair, or construct support facilities including central plants, boilers, administrative, classrooms, central kitchens, child care, physical education, music, art, visual and performing and fine arts classrooms or facilities, science, ceramics classrooms, auditoriums, special education classrooms, robotics, STEM/STEAM labs/classrooms, computer labs/classrooms, career technical facilities, makerspaces, culinary arts facilities, media centers/libraries and buildings, covered eating areas, shade and rain shelter, covered walkways, playgrounds and play equipment, administrative, transportation and maintenance facilities and yards; acquire modular/portable classrooms; repair, upgrade and replace fire and intrusion alarms and detectors, emergency communications, public address, speaker, and security systems, including security protections on windows, improve facilities to satisfy ADA and seismic requirements; as needed, removal of hazardous materials like asbestos, mold, and lead paint from older schools, as needed; install/improve/resurface or replace asphalt, broken concrete and improve hard courts, rubberized surfacing, walkways, turf, tracks, athletic and open fields, irrigation, and downspout drainage systems and campus landscaping; install and improve signage, way-finding flagpoles, solar electric systems, gates, and fencing; expand and improve parking and pick-up and drop-off areas and crosswalks; improve all site utilities; acquire or lease land; construct new school buildings; upgrade or replace interior and exterior painting, landscaping, floor covering, including carpets, and school facades and exterior finishes and casework; demolition; upgrade, repair, and construct kitchens, food service and school cafeterias; install, improve and construct trash enclosures; construct various forms of storage and support spaces and classrooms; improve quads; repair, upgrade, construct, and install interior and exterior lighting systems and back-up power generators; improve, construct, or replace playgrounds, play structures, athletic fields, concessions, bleachers, lockers/locker rooms, field lighting, field houses, gymnasiums, and facilities to support student health, fitness and safety; repair, install and replace outdated fences, including security fences and security systems (including access control systems, electronic locks, and cameras), provide lunch shelters, indoor space for assemblies or for rainy day lunch; upgrade, repair and construct music labs, multi-purpose and assembly rooms, theatres, student support spaces (including student services, counseling and nursing facilities), occupational therapy facilities, learning centers, wellness and media centers/spaces; add or upgrade parking lots and structures including solar systems and electric vehicle charging stations. In addition to the listed projects stated above, the Project List also includes the acquisition of a variety of instructional, maintenance and operational equipment, including the reduction or retirement of outstanding lease obligations and interim funding incurred to advance fund projects from the Project List; payment of the costs of preparation of all facility planning, facility studies, assessment reviews, facility master plan preparation and updates, environmental studies (including environmental investigation, remediation and monitoring), design and construction documentation, DSA oversight, and temporary housing of dislocated District activities caused by construction projects.

The upgrading of technology infrastructure includes, but is not limited to, upgrading, expanding, and acquiring classroom technology, wireless internet access and networks, portable interface devices, servers, switches, routers, computers, modules, sound projection systems, district-wide computer lab upgrades, interactive boards, cameras, sound projection, information systems, printers, digital white boards, upgrade voice-over-IP, communication systems, enterprise software, licenses and warranties, audio/visual and telecommunications systems, call manager and network security/firewall, Internet connectivity, wireless systems, technology infrastructure, disaster recovery and business continuity infrastructure (secondary sites, backup systems, redundant connectivity), information security systems, such as security monitoring and incident response infrastructure, including logging, SIEM/SOC tools, endpoint security, and data loss prevention and other miscellaneous IT and instructional equipment, DATA storage, fiber/copper infrastructure, phones, identity access cards, the creation and upgrading of technology for distance learning, acquire necessary software and the construction and installation of on-premises, cloud-based, or hybrid data center and related infrastructure for District enterprise systems, such as resource planning, websites, domain name systems, cloud applications and information security.

The budget for each project is an estimate and may be affected by factors beyond the District's control. Some projects throughout the District may be undertaken as joint use projects in cooperation with other local public or non-profit agencies. The final cost of each project will be determined as plans and construction documents are finalized, construction bids are received, construction contracts are awarded, and projects are completed. Based on the final costs of each project, certain of the projects described above may be delayed or may not be completed. Demolition of portable classrooms and existing facilities and reconstruction of facilities scheduled for repair and upgrade may occur if the Board determines that such an approach would be more cost-effective in creating more enhanced and operationally efficient campuses. Necessary site preparation/restoration and landscaping may occur in connection with new construction, renovation or remodeling, or installation or removal of relocatable or modular classrooms, including ingress and egress, removing, replacing, or installing irrigation or drainage systems, traffic signals, sewer or utility lines, trees and landscaping, relocating fire access roads, road widening, and acquiring any necessary easements, licenses, permits, or rights of way to the property.

The listed projects will be completed as needed. Each project is assumed to include its share of furniture, equipment, architectural, engineering, legal fees and similar planning costs, connection fees, program and project management, staff training expenses and a customary contingency for unforeseen design and construction costs. Proceeds of the bonds may be used to pay or reimburse the District for the cost of District bond audits and staff when performing work on or necessary and incidental to bond projects. Bond proceeds shall only be expended for the types of projects and purposes identified herein. The District shall create an account into which proceeds of the bonds shall be deposited and comply with the reporting requirements of Government Code § 53410.

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FISCAL ACCOUNTABILITY

THIS MEASURE REQUIRES A CLEAR SYSTEM OF ACCOUNTABILITY, INCLUDING A PROJECT LIST DETAILING HOW THE MONEY WILL BE USED, A CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE, AND INDEPENDENT AUDITS TO ENSURE MONEY IS SPENT PROPERLY.

In accordance with Education Code Section 15272, the Governing Board will appoint a citizens' oversight committee and conduct annual independent audits to ensure that funds are spent only on District projects and for no other purpose. The expenditure of bond money on these projects is subject to stringent financial accountability requirements. By law, performance and financial audits will be performed annually, and all bond expenditures will be monitored by an independent citizens' oversight committee to ensure that funds are spent as promised and specified. The citizens' oversight committee must include, among others, representation of a bona fide taxpayers' association, a business organization and a senior citizens organization. No District employees or vendors are allowed to serve on the citizens' oversight committee.

No Administrator Salaries: Proceeds from the sale of the bonds authorized by this proposition shall be used only for the acquisition, construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities, and not for any other purpose, including teacher and school administrator salaries and other operating expenses.

State Matching Funds. The following statement is included in this measure pursuant to Education Code Section 15122.5: Approval of Measure K does not guarantee that the proposed project or projects in the Fallbrook Union Elementary School District that are the subject of bonds under Measure K will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by Measure K. The school district's proposal for the project or projects may assume the receipt of matching state funds, which could be subject to appropriation by the Legislature or approval of a statewide bond measure.